

Company:BlackRock

Job Profile:Software Engineer

Offer Type: Intern + PPO (Performance based)

Stipend:50k

CTC:18 LPA

Location:Mumbai/Gurgaon

PPT (20-8-25) On Webex Platform (It was a Pool Campus Placement for SPIT and VIT)

Placement Process:

Online Assesment - 22-08-2025

Technical Round 1 - 28-08-2025

Technical Round 2 - 28-08-2025

HR - 29-08-2025

1. **Online Assessment Round** []

Level: Medium - Hard

Platform: eLitmus

Duration: Somewhat 1 Hr 30 min or 1Hr 45 min

- Timed sections on various topics like:
 - Aptitude
 - Reasoning
 - Verbal
 - Flowcharts
 - SQL
- All sections will be timed and there will be a window after each section where you can take a break after every section.
- For every question you can answer, go previous or skip for the time.

- When all questions of the section are done then the system will throw the skipped question so don't panic and waste your time on questions that you are not able to do at that moment.
- Just do all the questions as fast as possible.
- The DSA will be easy to medium.
 - Most questions in DSA was from tree data-structure, specially BST formation, preorder, postorder, and formation of the same.
 - I would recommend doing and practicing AVL Trees as well
As some of my friends were asked questions based on that
- The toughest question was from the critical thinking :
 - There was a problem statement and there was flowchart for that particular problem, for example platform assignment for a train.
 - You have to analyse the pseudo code and understand the flow chart.
 - There were 3-5 question on one flowchart.
 - There were around 2-3 flow-chart.
 - Every flow-chart was very big, bulky and contained around 5-8 decisions.
 - There were some empty blocks in the flow-chart which we had to fill by understanding the flow chart and by options given in the mcq.
- Last section was SQL, all about DBMS, do have a closer look to DBMS, specially very in-depth topics which no one teaches.

2. **Technical Round 1** [35 candidates appeared for this round]

So my technical round was scheduled at 9.30 am and it was an online interview on Webex Platform

Interview began with my introduction , keep it short and crisp , REMEMBER your entire interview will go around your introduction so make sure to say things you know , dont fake it

As well as dont even think or try to cheat on online interviews as many of them were caught by TPO and strict actions were taken

Then the very first question was asked to me about

What was my most recent project I have worked on ? Explaining the entire project , I started explaining The architecture of the project and the purpose of the project. There will be a lot of cross questioning on your projects so have thorough understanding on them

After some more chit chatting on projects and resume , panelist jumped on DSA

I was asked a famous question of Linked List (How to detect a Cycle in a Linked List)

As soon as i started with the optimal approach of Slow and Fast Pointers , the interviewer said me not to use this method and think of an optimal approach other than this

KEY Point - Never jump directly on optimal approaches , walk through brute better and optimal in a structured manner

Then after some time the next questions was on my primary language , I answered C++

Follow up question immediately - WHY C++ and not JAVA , what are the primary differences between them and some more questions around it were asked

Then the interviewer started asking about OOPS concepts

About Four Pillars and differences between them , I answered it very confidently using examples to demonstrate better understanding ,

Q) Applications with examples on all four pillars with understanding on each one of them and what are the differences between some concepts of OOPS in java and c++ like in c++ we can inherit from multiple parents and in java we cant , then whats the solution for java he asked and follow up on what i was saying

REMEMBER - he will ask follow ups on what you say and grill till a point he knows that you know the concepts well , so dont fake it answer it honestly.

Q) Difference between interfaces and abstraction , static , can we instantiate objects or not

Q)I am creating my own language in which we can instantiate static , What will be the core difficulties and challenges and how would you resolve them.

KEY - Deep Understanding of OOPS was very essential as half of my interview revolved around it

In between some Managerial HR type questions were also asked , just communicate well here nothing much for these questions,

Dont let any awkward silence to be created at any time , You can take some time from the interviewer to think and then answer , So just be confident and you are good to go

At the end of the interview he asked me about how good knowledge do you have about finance and like some common questions on do you manage your portfolio , what type of investments do you do and We discussed on that for about 5-10 minutes ,

Here you can show how eager you are to learn and break into finance

The discussion went so well that the interview started becoming a talking session .

Then he asked me about current affairs and what latest news I had read on BlackRock

I had read some news so I could answer these questions very well .

Then I was asked, "Do I have any questions for them ?

Never say no , always prepare some good questions to be asked at the end of the interview which gives them the feeling of eagerness to learn

TIP- However good your technical skills might be , but if you can't communicate and convey and make them understand about your thought process then its no use

So yes work on your soft skills as well

3. **Technical Round 2**

Dont know how many got call for 2nd interview

Round 2 was a bit more formal and short than the previous round , as usual started with my introduction and then on projects and resume as i mentioned in round 1

Then on a specific project he started grilling me

Q)Screen was shared and i was asked to open Notepad and write down schema of my project , how i passed that data on backend and questions related to storing them on databases

Q)I was asked to write a few SQL queries regarding the schema i made

Have a good knowledge of JOINS , GROUP BY , WINDOW FN , DATE FN and you are good to go

After this schema design and querying again we moved to OOPS

Started with fundamental questions and gradually complexity was increasing , so even if you dont know the exact answer , try to gather some points and convey the thought process in between

Q)I was asked on how i used concepts of OOPS in each project and how i utilized the four pillars

Here explain the architecture and gist of project and then go on with the answer to how OOPS played a major role in each projects in some or the other way

I wasnt asked many development questions , but my friends were asked questions on React and Backend , so read the JD for the role you are applying for and have ideas in some way or the other.

PRANK ROUND (THERE WAS NO HR)

During the BlackRock process, after finishing my two technical rounds, our TPC told us about the prank round that had been taken earlier by our TPO head, Mr. Vinod Sikka. On the same day, I also had an EDS interview scheduled at their office, so I was really stressed trying to manage both. While waiting for the BlackRock result, the tension kept building, but finally, my name was announced for the SDE role. That moment was such a big relief and honestly one of the happiest feelings—I realized how important it is to stay calm under pressure and I felt super excited to join BlackRock.

Read some more interview experiences on GFG as well of students from VIT

Useful Tips:

First of all let me walk you through my story of placements , I was relying on WorkIndia for Data Analyst role and I was just preparing for one single company and WorkIndia didnt come for DA role
So dont just focus on one specific company or one specific role.

Also there will be days where you will feel very lonely and very low, but that's all part of the process
There were about 20 companies before BlackRock and I wasnt able to clear OA for 18 of them.
Take help from your friends and seniors, give mock interviews , build up your confidence

Try to maintain a good CGPA above 7.5

Most of the companies have an eligibility criteria of above 7.5 and 7 so on a safer note 7.5

CONFIDENCE IS THE KEY

DONT GIVE UP

BELIEVE IN GODS PLAN

Put in your efforts as well

For DSA use the Striver's A-Z DSA sheet:

<https://takeuforward.org/strivers-a2z-dsa-course/strivers-a2z-dsa-course-sheet-2/>

Practice SQL 50 from Leetcode almost 2-3 times before the placement process starts

For Java OOPS refer to OOPS by Kunal Kushwaha:

https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PL9gnSGHSqcnolG3XjUbWzXHL8_EttOuKk

For CPP Fundamentals I referred to :

<https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLLYz8uHU480j37APNXBdPz7YzAi4XlQUF>

For React use the interviewbit's interview questions

Practice various kinds of MCQs again and again to get a strong grip on them

Use IndiaBix for aptitude and gfg for CS FUNDAMENTALS

DBMS: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dl00fOOYLOM&t=23431s>

For any queries, feel free to reach out on : <https://www.linkedin.com/in/dhruv-kanadia-1b236a25a/>